

The helpers

Sammy stores. Eddie runs. Lulu pops in.

Copy the Voice-over block. Timed lines are for editing. No storyteller kid in the picture — voice only.

VOICE-OVER (COPY THIS)

Welcome to Cloud Town, high up in the sky! Meet Sammy the Super Storage Box. Sammy is S3. He keeps photos, toys, and files safe forever. Here's Eddie. Eddie is EC2, a computer who never sleeps. He runs websites and games all day long. And this is Lulu. Lulu is Lambda. She pops in, does one job super fast, then poofs away. Together they make the cloud work. Now you know AWS!

TIMED LINES

0:00.00 – 0:03.00	Welcome to Cloud Town, high up in the sky!
0:03.00 – 0:05.50	Meet Sammy the Super Storage Box.
0:05.50 – 0:10.80	Sammy is S3. He keeps photos, toys, and files safe forever.
0:10.80 – 0:15.30	Here's Eddie. Eddie is EC2, a computer who never sleeps.
0:15.30 – 0:18.30	He runs websites and games all day long.
0:18.30 – 0:21.10	And this is Lulu. Lulu is Lambda.
0:21.10 – 0:25.30	She pops in, does one job super fast, then poofs away.
0:25.30 – 0:27.30	Together they make the cloud work.
0:27.30 – 0:30.00	Now you know AWS!

CHAPTERS

0:00.00 – 0:03.20	Cloud Town
0:03.20 – 0:10.90	Sammy · S3
0:10.90 – 0:18.40	Eddie · EC2
0:18.40 – 0:25.40	Lulu · Lambda
0:25.40 – 0:30.00	Together

NEIGHBORS (KID WORD = AWS)

Sammy = S3

Super Storage Box

Keeps photos, toys, and files safe forever.

Sammy is Amazon S3 — a giant storage box in the sky. When you save a drawing, a photo, or a file, Sammy tucks it away and never loses it. Think of a magic closet that never fills up.

Eddie = EC2

Always-On Computer

A computer who never sleeps, running websites and games.

Eddie is Amazon EC2 — a computer you can borrow in the cloud. He stays awake all day and all night so websites and games keep running, even while you sleep.

Lulu = Lambda

Magic Helper

Pops in, does one job super fast, then poofs away.

Lulu is AWS Lambda. She only appears when you need her — send a picture, count a score, zip a file — then she disappears. You don't keep a whole computer on. You just call Lulu.

QUIZ

1. Who keeps photos and files safe forever?

Choices: Sammy · Eddie · Lulu

Answer: [Sammy \(S3\)](#)

2. Who is the computer that never sleeps?

Choices: Sammy · Eddie · Lulu

Answer: [Eddie \(EC2\)](#)

3. Who pops in, does one job, then poofs away?

Choices: Sammy · Eddie · Lulu

Answer: [Lulu \(Lambda\)](#)

RECAP

Sammy stores. Eddie runs. Lulu pops in. That is the cloud.

Perfect! Sammy stores, Eddie runs, and Lulu pops in for one fast job. That's AWS.

Sammy's closet

Buckets, shelves, and the whole freezer family.

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VOICE-OVER (COPY THIS)

Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky! This is Episode 2. Meet Sammy the Super Storage Box. Sammy is S3. His closet is a bucket. Each drawing is an object. He never fills up. The everyday shelf is S3 Standard. You can open it any time. The dusty shelf is Infrequent Access. It is cheaper if you do not peek every day. One Zone-IA lives in just one yard. Intelligent-Tiering is a magic closet. It moves drawings to cheaper shelves by itself. Glacier Instant is a chilly drawer you can open right now. Glacier Flexible Retrieval waits a little. Glacier Deep Archive sleeps for years. Now you know Sammy's closet!

TIMED LINES

0:00.10 – 0:04.48	Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky!
0:04.48 – 0:06.93	This is Episode 2.
0:06.93 – 0:10.57	Meet Sammy the Super Storage Box.
0:10.57 – 0:13.09	Sammy is S3.
0:13.09 – 0:15.76	His closet is a bucket.
0:15.76 – 0:18.79	Each drawing is an object.
0:18.79 – 0:21.15	He never fills up.
0:21.15 – 0:25.03	The everyday shelf is S3 Standard.
0:25.03 – 0:27.76	You can open it any time.
0:27.76 – 0:31.48	The dusty shelf is Infrequent Access.
0:31.48 – 0:35.28	It is cheaper if you do not peek every day.
0:35.28 – 0:39.22	One Zone-IA lives in just one yard.
0:39.22 – 0:42.99	Intelligent-Tiering is a magic closet.
0:42.99 – 0:47.33	It moves drawings to cheaper shelves by itself.
0:47.33 – 0:52.05	Glacier Instant is a chilly drawer you can open right now.
0:52.05 – 0:55.80	Glacier Flexible Retrieval waits a little.
0:55.80 – 0:59.63	Glacier Deep Archive sleeps for years.
0:59.63 – 1:00.00	Now you know Sammy's closet!

CHAPTERS

0:00.00 – 0:21.15	Bucket
0:21.15 – 0:47.33	Shelves

0:47.33 – 1:00.00 Magic · freezer

NEIGHBORS (KID WORD = AWS)

Bucket = S3

The closet

A bucket holds objects. Each drawing is one object.

Amazon S3 is object storage. You make a bucket, then put objects in it — photos, files, backups. It scales without you buying a bigger box.

Shelves = Storage classes

Everyday, dusty, one-yard

Standard is everyday. Infrequent Access is dusty. One Zone-IA lives in one yard.

S3 Standard is for things you open a lot. Standard-IA and One Zone-IA cost less if you peek less often. One Zone-IA keeps copies in a single Availability Zone, so it is cheaper and less sturdy in a flood.

Magic closet = Intelligent-Tiering

It moves drawings by itself

If you stop opening a drawing, it slides to a cheaper shelf.

S3 Intelligent-Tiering watches how often you open objects and moves them between frequent, infrequent, and archive tiers. You pay a tiny watch fee.

Freezer family = S3 Glacier

Instant, Flexible, Deep Archive

Instant opens now. Flexible waits. Deep Archive sleeps for years.

Glacier Instant Retrieval is a chilly drawer you can open right away. Glacier Flexible Retrieval waits minutes to hours. Glacier Deep Archive is the cheapest, for treasures you may not need for years.

QUIZ

1. What is a bucket full of?

Choices: Bucket · Freezer family · Magic closet

Answer: [Bucket \(S3\)](#)

2. Which closet moves drawings to cheaper shelves by itself?

Choices: Shelves · Magic closet · Freezer family

Answer: [Magic closet \(Intelligent-Tiering\)](#)

3. Which freezer can you open right now?

Choices: Freezer family · Shelves · Bucket

Answer: [Freezer family \(S3 Glacier\)](#)

RECAP

Episode 2: a bucket, shelves, a magic sorter, and the freezer family. Tap Episode 3 for copies and locks.

Yes! A bucket holds objects. Standard is everyday. IA is dusty. Intelligent-Tiering sorts itself. Glacier has Instant, Flexible, and Deep Archive. Next: Episode 3 — copies and locks.

Copies and locks

Versioning, copies across towns, and doors that stay shut.

Copy the Voice-over block. Timed lines are for editing. No storyteller kid in the picture — voice only.

VOICE-OVER (COPY THIS)

Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky! This is Episode 3. Sammy keeps old drawings too. Versioning keeps the old drawing when you paint a new one. A lifecycle rule tucks old drawings into the freezer by itself. Sammy copies treasures into many buildings. Eleven nines means they almost never vanish. Cross-Region Replication sends a copy to another Cloud Town. Encryption is a padlock on the closet. Block Public Access keeps strangers out. Object Lock says this drawing may not be erased. Old drawings stay. Copies fly. Locks stay shut. Now you know copies and locks!

TIMED LINES

0:00.10 – 0:04.38	Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky!
0:04.38 – 0:06.80	This is Episode 3.
0:06.80 – 0:09.95	Sammy keeps old drawings too.
0:09.95 – 0:14.33	Versioning keeps the old drawing when you paint a new one.
0:14.33 – 0:19.96	A lifecycle rule tucks old drawings into the freezer by itself.
0:19.96 – 0:24.07	Sammy copies treasures into many buildings.
0:24.07 – 0:28.26	Eleven nines means they almost never vanish.
0:28.26 – 0:33.42	Cross-Region Replication sends a copy to another Cloud Town.
0:33.42 – 0:37.01	Encryption is a padlock on the closet.
0:37.01 – 0:40.85	Block Public Access keeps strangers out.
0:40.85 – 0:45.14	Object Lock says this drawing may not be erased.
0:45.14 – 0:47.46	Old drawings stay.
0:47.46 – 0:49.43	Copies fly.
0:49.43 – 0:51.59	Locks stay shut.
0:51.59 – 1:00.00	Now you know copies and locks!

CHAPTERS

0:00.00 – 0:19.96	Versions
0:19.96 – 0:33.42	Copies
0:33.42 – 1:00.00	Locks

NEIGHBORS (KID WORD = AWS)

Old drawings = Versioning · Lifecycle

Keep and tuck

Versioning keeps the old drawing. Lifecycle tucks old ones into the freezer.

Versioning keeps every copy when a drawing is replaced or deleted. A lifecycle rule can later move or expire objects — for example, Standard for 30 days, then Glacier.

Spare towns = Replication

Copies in many buildings

Eleven nines. A copy can fly to another Cloud Town.

S3 stores copies across Availability Zones. Durability is eleven nines. Cross-Region Replication copies a bucket to another Region. Same-Region Replication copies inside one Region.

Locks = Encryption · BPA · Object Lock

Padlock, shut door, glass case

Encryption locks it. Block Public Access keeps strangers out. Object Lock cannot be erased.

Encrypt with SSE-S3, SSE-KMS, or SSE-C. Turn on Block Public Access so a bucket is not a public shop by accident. Object Lock (WORM) can make an object impossible to delete until a date.

QUIZ

1. What keeps the old drawing when you paint a new one?

Choices: Locks · Old drawings · Spare towns

Answer: Old drawings (Versioning · Lifecycle)

2. What sends a copy to another Cloud Town?

Choices: Spare towns · Old drawings · Locks

Answer: Spare towns (Replication)

3. What says a drawing may not be erased?

Choices: Spare towns · Locks · Old drawings

Answer: Locks (Encryption · BPA · Object Lock)

RECAP

Episode 3: old drawings stay, copies fly, and locks stay shut. That is the rest of S3.

Yes! Versioning keeps history. Lifecycle tucks. Replication copies to another town. Encryption, Block Public Access, and Object Lock keep strangers out.

The neighborhood

A fence, a front street, a backyard, and a tunnel home.

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VOICE-OVER (COPY THIS)

Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky! Meet Vivi the fence. A VPC is our own private neighborhood. Front street is public. The backyard is private. Iggy is the Internet Gateway, the big front gate! Albie the doorman greets visitors on the public street. Eddie the computer and Dot the vault hide in the backyard. Nat the mail window lets Eddie go out, but strangers cannot come in. That's egress! A sky bridge links another town. A secret tunnel reaches a house on the ground. Now you know the neighborhood!

TIMED LINES

0:00.00 – 0:02.80	Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky!
0:02.80 – 0:04.30	Meet Vivi the fence.
0:04.30 – 0:06.90	A VPC is our own private neighborhood.
0:06.90 – 0:08.20	Front street is public.
0:08.20 – 0:10.00	The backyard is private.
0:10.00 – 0:13.10	Iggy is the Internet Gateway, the big front gate!
0:13.10 – 0:16.10	Albie the doorman greets visitors on the public street.
0:16.10 – 0:19.30	Eddie the computer and Dot the vault hide in the backyard.
0:19.30 – 0:23.10	Nat the mail window lets Eddie go out, but strangers cannot come in.
0:23.10 – 0:24.30	That's egress!
0:24.30 – 0:26.30	A sky bridge links another town.
0:26.30 – 0:28.80	A secret tunnel reaches a house on the ground.
0:28.80 – 0:30.00	Now you know the neighborhood!

CHAPTERS

0:00.00 – 0:06.00	VPC fence
0:06.00 – 0:12.00	Public · Private
0:12.00 – 0:18.00	Internet Gateway
0:18.00 – 0:24.00	NAT · egress
0:24.00 – 0:30.00	Bridge · tunnel

NEIGHBORS (KID WORD = AWS)

Vivi = VPC

The fence

Your own private neighborhood in the sky.

A VPC is a Virtual Private Cloud — a fenced town that belongs to you. Everything inside (streets, computers, vaults) is yours. Other towns cannot wander in unless you build a bridge or a tunnel.

Albie = ALB

The doorman

Lives on the public street. Greets visitors and sends them to the right house.

Albie is an Application Load Balancer. He stands on the public subnet, the front street with a door to the internet. Friends arrive at Albie first. He checks they are welcome, then sends each one to a healthy Eddie.

Eddie = EC2

The shop in the backyard

Builds the website. Lives on the private street so strangers cannot knock.

Eddie still is EC2, but now you can see where he lives. In a real neighborhood he sits in a private subnet. The internet cannot reach him directly. Only Albie may talk to him.

Dot = Database

The vault

Hides in the private backyard. Visitors never meet her.

Dot is the database. She keeps the real treasure. She lives only in a private subnet, with no door to the internet. Eddie may whisper to her. A stranger at the gate may not.

Iggie = Internet Gateway

The big gate

The only door between Cloud Town and the whole internet.

Iggie is the Internet Gateway attached to the VPC. Public streets can use Iggie so visitors may come in to Albie. Private backyards do not plug into Iggie directly.

Nat = NAT Gateway

The mail window

Private computers may go out. Strangers may not come in. That is egress.

Nat is a NAT Gateway on the public street. Egress means going out. Eddie can send a letter through Nat and Iggie to the internet. A stranger cannot start a visit the other way.

QUIZ

1. Who lives on the public street and greets visitors?

Choices: Albie · Eddie · Dot

Answer: Albie (ALB)

2. Where should the database vault live?

Choices: Albie · Iggie · Dot

Answer: Dot (Database)

3. Who lets Eddie go out, but stops strangers coming in?

Choices: Nat · Albie · house

Answer: Nat (NAT Gateway)

4. What is the fence around the whole neighborhood?

Choices: Vivi · Iggie · Nat

Answer: Vivi (VPC)

RECAP

Albie greets. Eddie builds. Dot hides. Nat sends mail out. Iggie is the gate. That is the neighborhood.

Yes! Public street: Albie. Private backyard: Eddie and Dot. Iggie is the gate. Nat is egress. A bridge or a tunnel talks to other towns and home.

The other boxes

A backpack, a fridge, fancy cupboards, a door at home, and a spare.

Copy the Voice-over block. Timed lines are for editing. No storyteller kid in the picture — voice only.

VOICE-OVER (COPY THIS)

Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky! Sammy the Super Storage Box has a surprise. He has more than one closet! First, meet Eddie's backpack disk. That is EBS. It belongs to one Eddie and travels with him. Next, the shared fridge. That is EFS. Many Eddies can open it at the same time. These fancy cupboards are FSx. Way in the back is the deep freezer. That is S3 Glacier. Old drawings sleep here. It is cheap, and slow to open. A little door at home is Storage Gateway. And this is Backup, the spare-copy machine. Now you know Sammy's closets!

TIMED LINES

0:00.00 – 0:03.20	Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky!
0:03.20 – 0:06.40	Sammy the Super Storage Box has a surprise.
0:06.40 – 0:08.70	He has more than one closet!
0:08.70 – 0:13.00	First, meet Eddie's backpack disk. That is EBS.
0:13.00 – 0:17.10	It belongs to one Eddie and travels with him.
0:17.10 – 0:21.00	Next, the shared fridge. That is EFS.
0:21.00 – 0:25.40	Many Eddies can open it at the same time.
0:25.40 – 0:32.90	These fancy cupboards are FSx.
0:32.90 – 0:37.20	Way in the back is the deep freezer. That is S3 Glacier.
0:37.20 – 0:42.00	Old drawings sleep here. It is cheap, and slow to open.
0:42.00 – 0:48.50	A little door at home is Storage Gateway.
0:48.50 – 0:54.90	And this is Backup, the spare-copy machine.
0:54.90 – 1:00.00	Now you know Sammy's closets!

CHAPTERS

0:00.00 – 0:08.70	Many closets
0:08.70 – 0:17.10	EBS
0:17.10 – 0:25.40	EFS
0:25.40 – 0:33.00	FSx
0:33.00 – 0:42.00	Glacier
0:42.00 – 1:00.00	Gateway · Backup

NEIGHBORS (KID WORD = AWS)

Backpack = EBS

Eddie's disk

A disk that belongs to one Eddie and travels with him.

Amazon EBS is a disk attached to one EC2 computer. If Eddie moves to another street, he can take the backpack.

Fridge = EFS

The shared fridge

Many Eddies open the same snack at once.

Amazon EFS is a shared file system. Lots of computers can read and write the same files at the same time.

Cupboards = FSx

Special cupboards

Windows, Lustre, NetApp, or OpenZFS — picky programs get their cupboard.

Amazon FSx is managed file storage in flavors. AWS looks after the cupboard for you.

Freezer = S3 Glacier

The deep freezer

Old drawings sleep here. Cheap, and slow to open.

S3 Glacier is cold storage. See Episode 2 for Instant, Flexible, and Deep Archive.

Door = Storage Gateway

The closet door at home

Open a door on the ground, and you are in Sammy's sky closet.

AWS Storage Gateway is a door at home that talks to S3, FSx, or backup in the cloud.

Spare-copy = AWS Backup

The spare-copy machine

One button, and every treasure gets a spare.

AWS Backup copies many kinds of boxes at once on a schedule.

QUIZ

1. Which disk belongs to one Eddie and travels with him?

Choices: Backpack · Fridge · Freezer

Answer: Backpack (EBS)

2. Which fridge can many Eddies open at once?

Choices: Backpack · Fridge · Spare-copy

Answer: Fridge (EFS)

3. Where do old drawings sleep cheaply?

Choices: Cupboards · Freezer · Door

Answer: Freezer (S3 Glacier)

4. What is the spare-copy machine?

Choices: Spare-copy · Door · Backpack

Answer: Spare-copy (AWS Backup)

RECAP

EBS travels with Eddie. EFS is shared. FSx is picky. Glacier is cold. Gateway is a door at home. Backup makes a spare.

Yes! EBS is a backpack. EFS is a shared fridge. FSx is a special cupboard. Glacier is a freezer. Storage Gateway is a door at home. Backup makes a spare.

The key keepers

Name tags, school badges, guest stickers, and a shared swing.

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VOICE-OVER (COPY THIS)

Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky! This is Episode 6. A town with no keys is not safe. A town with one shared key is not safe either. Meet the key ring. That is IAM. Users have name tags. Groups are a whole class. A role is a badge you borrow for one job. A policy is the list of may and may-not. Identity Center is one school badge that opens many classrooms. Cognito is a guest sticker for friends who do not live here. Directory Service brings the old class list into the sky. RAM shares a swing, not the house key. Now you know the key keepers!

TIMED LINES

0:00.10 – 0:04.38	Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky!
0:04.38 – 0:06.97	This is Episode 6.
0:06.97 – 0:10.43	A town with no keys is not safe.
0:10.43 – 0:14.68	A town with one shared key is not safe either.
0:14.68 – 0:16.79	Meet the key ring.
0:16.79 – 0:18.87	That is IAM.
0:18.87 – 0:21.66	Users have name tags.
0:21.66 – 0:24.34	Groups are a whole class.
0:24.34 – 0:28.24	A role is a badge you borrow for one job.
0:28.24 – 0:32.00	A policy is the list of may and may-not.
0:32.00 – 0:37.55	Identity Center is one school badge that opens many classrooms.
0:37.55 – 0:42.51	Cognito is a guest sticker for friends who do not live here.
0:42.51 – 0:47.43	Directory Service brings the old class list into the sky.
0:47.43 – 0:51.21	RAM shares a swing, not the house key.
0:51.21 – 1:00.00	Now you know the key keepers!

CHAPTERS

0:00.00 – 0:32.00	Key ring
0:32.00 – 0:42.51	Badge · sticker
0:42.51 – 1:00.00	Swing

NEIGHBORS (KID WORD = AWS)

Key ring = IAM

Users, groups, roles, may and may-not

Name tags, a whole class, a borrowed badge, and the list of may and may-not.

AWS IAM is the key ring. Users are people. Groups are a class of people. A role is a badge you borrow for one job.

A policy is the list of may and may-not on Sammy, Eddie, or Dot.

School badge = IAM Identity Center

One badge, many classrooms

One school badge opens many classrooms.

IAM Identity Center is one sign-in that opens many AWS accounts and apps — one school badge, many doors.

Guest sticker = Amazon Cognito

Friends who do not live here

A guest sticker for lemonade-stand visitors — not a house key.

Amazon Cognito gives guest stickers to app users who do not live in Cloud Town. They can sign in without becoming IAM users.

Class list = Directory Service

The old list in the sky

The old class list (Active Directory) comes up to Cloud Town.

AWS Directory Service brings Microsoft Active Directory into AWS so the old class list still works in the sky.

Shared swing = AWS RAM

Share the swing, keep the house key

Share a swing with the next-door yard — without handing over the house key.

AWS Resource Access Manager lets one neighborhood share a resource with another account — a subnet, a resolver — without copying the house key.

QUIZ

1. Who is the key ring for the whole town?

Choices: Key ring · Guest sticker · Shared swing

Answer: [Key ring \(IAM\)](#)

2. What is a guest sticker for friends who do not live here?

Choices: School badge · Guest sticker · Key ring

Answer: [Guest sticker \(Amazon Cognito\)](#)

3. What shares a swing, not the house key?

Choices: Shared swing · Class list · School badge

Answer: [Shared swing \(AWS RAM\)](#)

RECAP

IAM is the key ring. A school badge opens many doors. Guests get stickers. RAM shares a swing. That is how keys work together.

Yes! IAM is the key ring. Identity Center is one school badge. Cognito is a guest sticker. Directory Service is the old class list. RAM shares a swing, not the house key.

The key ring

User, role, policy, SCP, and STS.

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VOICE-OVER (COPY THIS)

Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky! This is Episode 7. Today we open the key ring all the way. That is IAM. A user is a kid with a name tag. That kid lives in town. A role is a badge you borrow for one job, then you give it back. A policy is the list of may and may-not on the door. An SCP is the principal's rule. No classroom may break it, even if a teacher says yes. STS is a visitor pass that peels off at sunset. You borrow keys for a little while, then they vanish. Name tag. Borrowed badge. Door list. Principal's rule. Sunset pass. Now you know IAM!

TIMED LINES

0:00.10 – 0:04.38	Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky!
0:04.38 – 0:06.91	This is Episode 7.
0:06.91 – 0:10.51	Today we open the key ring all the way.
0:10.51 – 0:12.59	That is IAM.
0:12.59 – 0:16.00	A user is a kid with a name tag.
0:16.00 – 0:18.61	That kid lives in town.
0:18.61 – 0:23.97	A role is a badge you borrow for one job, then you give it back.
0:23.97 – 0:28.39	A policy is the list of may and may-not on the door.
0:28.39 – 0:31.84	An SCP is the principal's rule.
0:31.84 – 0:36.85	No classroom may break it, even if a teacher says yes.
0:36.85 – 0:41.66	STS is a visitor pass that peels off at sunset.
0:41.66 – 0:46.17	You borrow keys for a little while, then they vanish.
0:46.17 – 0:48.00	Name tag.
0:48.00 – 0:49.96	Borrowed badge.
0:49.96 – 0:51.78	Door list.
0:51.78 – 0:53.84	Principal's rule.
0:53.84 – 0:56.00	Sunset pass.
0:56.00 – 1:00.00	Now you know IAM!

CHAPTERS

0:00.00 – 0:23.97	User · role
0:23.97 – 0:36.85	Policy · SCP
0:36.85 – 1:00.00	STS

NEIGHBORS (KID WORD = AWS)

Name tag = IAM user

A kid who lives in town

A user is a kid with a name tag. That kid lives here.

An IAM user is a long-lived identity in your account — a person or a program with its own name tag. Prefer roles for jobs that can borrow keys instead.

Borrowed badge = IAM role

One job, then give it back

A role is a badge you borrow for one job, then you give it back.

An IAM role is a set of permissions you assume. EC2, Lambda, and people in other accounts can borrow it. Nobody keeps the badge in their pocket forever.

Door list = IAM policy

May and may-not

A policy is the list of may and may-not on the door.

An IAM policy is JSON that Allow or Deny actions on resources. Identity policies hang on users, groups, and roles. Resource policies hang on Sammy's bucket or a KMS lock.

Principal's rule = SCP

No classroom may break it

An SCP is the principal's rule. Even if a teacher says yes, the classroom still may not.

A Service Control Policy is a guardrail from AWS Organizations. It limits every account in the family. An Allow in IAM cannot beat an SCP Deny — the principal's book sits above the classroom.

Sunset pass = AWS STS

Keys that vanish

STS is a visitor pass that peels off at sunset. You borrow keys, then they vanish.

AWS Security Token Service hands out temporary credentials when you assume a role. Access key, secret, and session token expire. That is safer than a permanent name-tag password.

QUIZ

1. Who is a kid with a name tag who lives in town?

Choices: Name tag · Borrowed badge · Sunset pass

Answer: Name tag (IAM user)

2. What is a badge you borrow for one job, then give back?

Choices: Name tag · Borrowed badge · Door list

Answer: Borrowed badge (IAM role)

3. Which rule no classroom may break, even if a teacher says yes?

Choices: Door list · Principal's rule · Sunset pass

Answer: Principal's rule (SCP)

4. What peels off at sunset?

Choices: Sunset pass · Borrowed badge · Principal's rule

Answer: [Sunset pass](#) ([AWS STS](#))

RECAP

Name tag. Borrowed badge. Door list. Principal's rule. Sunset pass. That is IAM, working together.

Yes! A user has a name tag. A role is borrowed. A policy is may and may-not. An SCP is the principal's rule. STS is a sunset pass.

The school badge

One badge, many classrooms — not a name tag, not a guest sticker.

Copy the Voice-over block. Timed lines are for editing. No storyteller kid in the picture — voice only.

VOICE-OVER (COPY THIS)

Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky! This is Episode 8. The school badge is IAM Identity Center. One badge opens many classrooms. The office picks the class list. That is the identity source. Cloud Town's own list, the old class list, or another school. A permission set is which rooms the badge opens. Each classroom is an AWS account. You sign in once. This is not an IAM name tag. A name tag only works in one house. This is not a Cognito guest sticker. Guest stickers are for lemonade. The school badge is for the whole school. Now you know Identity Center!

TIMED LINES

0:00.10 – 0:04.38	Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky!
0:04.38 – 0:06.71	This is Episode 8.
0:06.71 – 0:10.54	The school badge is IAM Identity Center.
0:10.54 – 0:14.03	One badge opens many classrooms.
0:14.03 – 0:17.13	The office picks the class list.
0:17.13 – 0:19.96	That is the identity source.
0:19.96 – 0:25.67	Cloud Town's own list, the old class list, or another school.
0:25.67 – 0:29.80	A permission set is which rooms the badge opens.
0:29.80 – 0:33.70	Each classroom is an AWS account.
0:33.70 – 0:36.08	You sign in once.
0:36.08 – 0:39.35	This is not an IAM name tag.
0:39.35 – 0:43.03	A name tag only works in one house.
0:43.03 – 0:46.59	This is not a Cognito guest sticker.
0:46.59 – 0:49.71	Guest stickers are for lemonade.
0:49.71 – 0:53.01	The school badge is for the whole school.
0:53.01 – 1:00.00	Now you know Identity Center!

CHAPTERS

0:00.00 – 0:14.03	School badge
0:14.03 – 0:25.67	Class list
0:25.67 – 0:36.08	Permission set
0:36.08 – 1:00.00	Not those

NEIGHBORS (KID WORD = AWS)

School badge = IAM Identity Center

One badge, many classrooms

Sign in once. The badge opens the rooms you may enter.

IAM Identity Center (AWS SSO) is one sign-in for many AWS accounts and apps. It lives with AWS Organizations.

You do not make an IAM user in every account.

Class list = Identity source

Who the office trusts

Cloud Town's own list, the old class list, or another school.

The identity source can be Identity Center's own directory, Active Directory, or an external IdP (SAML / OIDC). That is who may receive a school badge.

Room list = Permission set

Which rooms the badge opens

One schedule, copied into every classroom (every AWS account).

A permission set is a template of IAM policies. Identity Center turns it into an IAM role in each assigned account.

That is how one badge opens many rooms.

Name tag = IAM user

Only one house

A name tag only works in one house. That is not Identity Center.

An IAM user lives in a single AWS account. Identity Center is for many accounts with one sign-in. Prefer Identity Center plus roles over long-lived IAM users.

Guest sticker = Amazon Cognito

Lemonade app, not school

Guest stickers are for the lemonade app. The school badge is for the whole school.

Cognito is for app users — customers of your lemonade stand. Identity Center is for workforce users — kids and teachers who work in Cloud Town's accounts.

QUIZ

1. What is one badge that opens many classrooms?

Choices: School badge · Name tag · Guest sticker

Answer: School badge (IAM Identity Center)

2. What is which rooms the badge opens?

Choices: Class list · Room list · Guest sticker

Answer: Room list (Permission set)

3. What only works in one house?

Choices: School badge · Name tag · Room list

Answer: Name tag (IAM user)

4. What is a guest sticker for the lemonade app?

Cloud Town · copyable voice-over script

Choices: Guest sticker · School badge · Class list

Answer: Guest sticker (Amazon Cognito)

RECAP

One badge. Many classrooms. Not a name tag. Not a guest sticker. That is Identity Center.

Yes! Identity Center is the school badge. The office picks the class list. A permission set is which rooms open. A name tag is one house. Cognito is lemonade.

The guest sticker

User pools, identity pools, lemonade guests — not town workers.

Copy the Voice-over block. Timed lines are for editing. No storyteller kid in the picture — voice only.

VOICE-OVER (COPY THIS)

Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky! This is Episode 9. Meet the guest sticker. That is Amazon Cognito. It is for friends who buy lemonade, not for kids who work in town. A user pool is the lemonade club list. Guests sign up and get a sticker. An identity pool is a tray of sunset passes. A guest can peek at one drawing, then the pass peels off. That uses STS. You can sign in at the lemonade window. Or use a badge from another playground. This is not IAM. A name tag is for workers. This is not Identity Center. A school badge is for the whole school. Cognito is for the lemonade stand. Now you know Cognito!

TIMED LINES

0:00.10 – 0:04.27	Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky!
0:04.27 – 0:06.68	This is Episode 9.
0:06.68 – 0:09.04	Meet the guest sticker.
0:09.04 – 0:11.96	That is Amazon Cognito.
0:11.96 – 0:17.27	It is for friends who buy lemonade, not for kids who work in town.
0:17.27 – 0:21.00	A user pool is the lemonade club list.
0:21.00 – 0:24.01	Guests sign up and get a sticker.
0:24.01 – 0:28.26	An identity pool is a tray of sunset passes.
0:28.26 – 0:33.08	A guest can peek at one drawing, then the pass peels off.
0:33.08 – 0:35.62	That uses STS.
0:35.62 – 0:39.26	You can sign in at the lemonade window.
0:39.26 – 0:42.64	Or use a badge from another playground.
0:42.64 – 0:44.90	This is not IAM.
0:44.90 – 0:47.86	A name tag is for workers.
0:47.86 – 0:50.76	This is not Identity Center.
0:50.76 – 0:53.92	A school badge is for the whole school.
0:53.92 – 0:57.32	Cognito is for the lemonade stand.
0:57.32 – 1:00.00	Now you know Cognito!

CHAPTERS

0:00.00 – 0:17.27	Guest sticker
0:17.27 – 0:35.62	Two pools

0:35.62 – 1:00.00 Not those

NEIGHBORS (KID WORD = AWS)

Guest sticker = Amazon Cognito

Lemonade friends, not town workers

Cognito is for friends who buy lemonade, not for kids who work in town.

Amazon Cognito is customer identity for your app. Workforce sign-in belongs to IAM Identity Center. Do not mix the lemonade stand with the school office.

Club list = User pool

Guests sign up

A user pool is the lemonade club list. Guests sign up and get a sticker.

A Cognito user pool stores app users, handles sign-up, sign-in, MFA, and groups, and hands out JWT tokens. It does not grant AWS API keys by itself.

Sunset tray = Identity pool

Peek, then the pass peels off

An identity pool is a tray of sunset passes. That uses STS.

A Cognito identity pool (federated identities) exchanges a user-pool token or social login for temporary AWS credentials from STS, so a guest can read one object in S3 without becoming an IAM user.

Name tag = IAM user

For workers

A name tag is for workers. That is not Cognito.

IAM users are long-lived identities inside one AWS account. Cognito guests should not be IAM users.

School badge = IAM Identity Center

For the whole school

A school badge is for the whole school. Cognito is for the lemonade stand.

Identity Center is workforce SSO across accounts. Cognito is customer identity for an app.

QUIZ

1. Who is the guest sticker for lemonade friends?

Choices: Guest sticker · Name tag · School badge

Answer: Guest sticker (Amazon Cognito)

2. What is the lemonade club list where guests sign up?

Choices: Club list · Sunset tray · School badge

Answer: Club list (User pool)

3. What is a tray of sunset passes that uses STS?

Choices: Club list · Sunset tray · Name tag

Answer: Sunset tray (Identity pool)

4. What is for the whole school, not the lemonade stand?

Choices: School badge · Guest sticker · Club list

Answer: School badge (IAM Identity Center)

RECAP

Club list. Sunset passes. Not a name tag. Not a school badge. Cognito is for lemonade.

Yes! Cognito is the guest sticker. A user pool is the club list. An identity pool is sunset passes via STS. IAM is workers. Identity Center is school.

The vaults

Pick the vault that matches the treasure.

Copy the Voice-over block. Timed lines are for editing. No storyteller kid in the picture — voice only.

VOICE-OVER (COPY THIS)

Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky! This is Episode 10. Meet Dot. She is a vault. But Dot is not only one vault. RDS is a tidy notebook. AWS turns the pages. Aurora is the super notebook. Extra copies. Extra fast. Aurora Serverless wakes when you write, then naps. DynamoDB is labeled cubbies. Grab by name. Super fast. ElastiCache is the snack already unwrapped. DocumentDB keeps JSON stories. Neptune is a family tree. Keyspaces are wide cubbies. Pick the vault that matches the treasure. Now you know the vaults!

TIMED LINES

0:00.10 – 0:04.38	Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky!
0:04.38 – 0:06.84	This is Episode 10.
0:06.84 – 0:08.58	Meet Dot.
0:08.58 – 0:10.59	She is a vault.
0:10.59 – 0:13.79	But Dot is not only one vault.
0:13.79 – 0:16.88	RDS is a tidy notebook.
0:16.88 – 0:20.12	AWS turns the pages.
0:20.12 – 0:23.13	Aurora is the super notebook.
0:23.13 – 0:25.28	Extra copies.
0:25.28 – 0:27.30	Extra fast.
0:27.30 – 0:31.84	Aurora Serverless wakes when you write, then naps.
0:31.84 – 0:35.22	DynamoDB is labeled cubbies.
0:35.22 – 0:37.25	Grab by name.
0:37.25 – 0:39.30	Super fast.
0:39.30 – 0:43.34	ElastiCache is the snack already unwrapped.
0:43.34 – 0:47.24	DocumentDB keeps JSON stories.
0:47.24 – 0:50.17	Neptune is a family tree.
0:50.17 – 0:53.25	Keyspaces are wide cubbies.
0:53.25 – 0:56.50	Pick the vault that matches the treasure.
0:56.50 – 1:00.00	Now you know the vaults!

CHAPTERS

0:00.00 – 0:20.12 Notebooks

0:20.12 – 0:31.84 Super notebook

0:31.84 – 0:39.30 Cubbies

0:39.30 – 1:00.00 Snacks and trees

NEIGHBORS (KID WORD = AWS)

Dot = Databases

Not only one vault

Dot is a vault. Real towns pick a vault that matches the treasure.

On the SAA exam, “database” is a family. Choose RDS/Aurora for SQL, DynamoDB for key-value, ElastiCache for hot repeats, and specialty stores for documents, graphs, or wide columns.

Tidy notebook = Amazon RDS

AWS turns the pages

RDS is a tidy notebook with rows and columns. AWS turns the pages.

Amazon RDS is managed SQL (MySQL, PostgreSQL, MariaDB, SQL Server, Oracle). AWS handles patching, backups, and Multi-AZ. You pick the engine and size.

Super notebook = Amazon Aurora

Extra copies, extra fast

Aurora is the super notebook. Extra copies. Extra fast. Serverless wakes, then naps.

Aurora is MySQL/PostgreSQL-compatible and faster than RDS, with storage that replicas share. Aurora Serverless scales to zero-ish when idle — it naps until you write.

Labeled cubbies = Amazon DynamoDB

Grab by name

DynamoDB is labeled cubbies. Grab by name. Super fast.

DynamoDB is a serverless NoSQL key-value and document store. You look items up by primary key. It is not SQL joins. Use it when you know the name of the cubby.

Unwrapped snack = Amazon ElastiCache

Repeats come instantly

ElastiCache is the snack already unwrapped — Redis or Memcached.

ElastiCache sits in front of a vault so hot reads do not hit the notebook every time. Redis and Memcached. Data can vanish if the cache restarts — the real vault still holds the treasure.

QUIZ

1. What is the tidy notebook AWS turns the pages for?

Choices: Tidy notebook · Labeled cubbies · Unwrapped snack

Answer: Tidy notebook (Amazon RDS)

2. What is the super notebook with extra copies?

Choices: Tidy notebook · Super notebook · Dot

Answer: Super notebook (Amazon Aurora)

3. What is labeled cubbies you grab by name?

Choices: Labeled cubbies · Tidy notebook · Unwrapped snack

Answer: [Labeled cubbies](#) ([Amazon DynamoDB](#))

4. What is the snack already unwrapped?

Choices: Unwrapped snack · Super notebook · Dot

Answer: [Unwrapped snack](#) ([Amazon ElastiCache](#))

RECAP

Notebook. Super notebook. Cubbies. Unwrapped snack. Pick the vault that matches the treasure.

Yes! RDS is the tidy notebook. Aurora is the super notebook. DynamoDB is cubbies. ElastiCache is the unwrapped snack. Pick the vault that matches the treasure.

The tidy notebook

AWS turns the pages.

Copy the Voice-over block. Timed lines are for editing. No storyteller kid in the picture — voice only.

VOICE-OVER (COPY THIS)

Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky! This is Episode 11. RDS is Amazon RDS. A tidy notebook with rows and columns. AWS turns the pages. You pick the brand. MySQL. PostgreSQL. And more. Eddie asks Dot in the backyard. Visitors never meet her. That is a private street. If one notebook gets sleepy, a spare waits in the other yard. That is Multi-AZ. A reading copy keeps the line short. That is a replica. At night, AWS photocopies the pages. Those are backups. AWS does the grown-up jobs. Now you know RDS!

TIMED LINES

0:00.10 – 0:04.38	Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky!
0:04.38 – 0:06.96	This is Episode 11.
0:06.96 – 0:10.38	RDS is Amazon RDS.
0:10.38 – 0:14.22	A tidy notebook with rows and columns.
0:14.22 – 0:17.47	AWS turns the pages.
0:17.47 – 0:19.68	You pick the brand.
0:19.68 – 0:21.66	MySQL.
0:21.66 – 0:23.82	PostgreSQL.
0:23.82 – 0:25.43	And more.
0:25.43 – 0:28.45	Eddie asks Dot in the backyard.
0:28.45 – 0:31.07	Visitors never meet her.
0:31.07 – 0:33.67	That is a private street.
0:33.67 – 0:38.87	If one notebook gets sleepy, a spare waits in the other yard.
0:38.87 – 0:41.25	That is Multi-AZ.
0:41.25 – 0:44.76	A reading copy keeps the line short.
0:44.76 – 0:46.97	That is a replica.
0:46.97 – 0:51.42	At night, AWS photocopies the pages.
0:51.42 – 0:53.67	Those are backups.
0:53.67 – 0:57.24	AWS does the grown-up jobs.
0:57.24 – 1:00.00	Now you know RDS!

CHAPTERS

0:00.00 – 0:17.47 Notebook

0:17.47 – 0:25.43 Brands

0:25.43 – 0:33.67 Backyard

0:33.67 – 0:41.25 Spare yard

0:41.25 – 0:46.97 Replica

0:46.97 – 1:00.00 Backups

NEIGHBORS (KID WORD = AWS)

Tidy notebook = Amazon RDS

AWS turns the pages

RDS is a notebook with rows and columns. You pick the brand. AWS turns the pages.

Amazon RDS is managed SQL: MySQL, PostgreSQL, MariaDB, SQL Server, and Oracle. You choose the engine and size. AWS patches, backs up, and fails over. Do not run the database on EC2 unless you must.

Eddie = Private backyard

Visitors never meet her

Eddie asks Dot in the backyard. That is a private street.

Put RDS in a private subnet. The app (EC2, ECS, Lambda) talks to it. The internet does not. Security groups allow only the app. A public RDS is almost never the SAA answer.

Spare yard = Multi-AZ

Already waiting

If one notebook gets sleepy, a spare waits in the other yard. That is Multi-AZ.

RDS Multi-AZ keeps a synchronous standby in another Availability Zone. Failover is automatic. The standby is for disaster, not extra read traffic. Use read replicas for reads.

Reading copy = Read replica

Keeps the line short

A reading copy keeps the line short. That is a replica.

A read replica is an asynchronous copy for SELECT traffic. It is not Multi-AZ. Promote a replica if you need a new writer. Cross-Region replicas help disaster recovery and local reads.

Night photocopies = Automated backups

AWS copies the pages

At night, AWS photocopies the pages. Those are backups.

RDS automated backups plus transaction logs let you restore to a point in time. Manual snapshots stay until you delete them. Encryption uses KMS. You do not patch the OS — AWS does the grown-up jobs.

QUIZ

1. What is the tidy notebook AWS turns the pages for?

Choices: Tidy notebook · Spare yard · Reading copy

Answer: Tidy notebook (Amazon RDS)

2. What is a spare notebook already waiting in the other yard?

Choices: Spare yard · Reading copy · Night photocopies

Answer: Spare yard (Multi-AZ)

3. What is a copy just for reading so the line stays short?

Choices: Reading copy · Spare yard · Eddie

Answer: Reading copy (Read replica)

4. What are the night-time photocopies of the pages?

Choices: Night photocopies · Tidy notebook · Eddie

Answer: Night photocopies (Automated backups)

RECAP

Private backyard. Spare yard. Reading copy. Night photocopies. AWS turns the pages.

Yes! RDS is the tidy notebook. Multi-AZ is the spare yard. A replica is for reading. Backups are night photocopies.

AWS turns the pages.

The super notebook

Extra copies. Extra fast. Then it naps.

Copy the Voice-over block. Timed lines are for editing. No storyteller kid in the picture — voice only.

VOICE-OVER (COPY THIS)

Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky! This is Episode 12. RDS is a tidy notebook. Aurora is the super notebook. Extra copies. Extra fast. It still speaks MySQL. It still speaks PostgreSQL. All the notebooks share one big pile of pages. Write once. Everyone can read. Extra copies help the line stay short. Those are replicas. They share the same pile. When nobody writes, Aurora Serverless takes a nap. When Eddie writes, it wakes up. AWS grows the pages. Now you know Aurora!

TIMED LINES

0:00.10 – 0:04.38	Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky!
0:04.38 – 0:06.99	This is Episode 12.
0:06.99 – 0:10.08	RDS is a tidy notebook.
0:10.08 – 0:13.09	Aurora is the super notebook.
0:13.09 – 0:15.24	Extra copies.
0:15.24 – 0:17.26	Extra fast.
0:17.26 – 0:20.37	It still speaks MySQL.
0:20.37 – 0:23.67	It still speaks PostgreSQL.
0:23.67 – 0:28.11	All the notebooks share one big pile of pages.
0:28.11 – 0:30.00	Write once.
0:30.00 – 0:32.29	Everyone can read.
0:32.29 – 0:35.99	Extra copies help the line stay short.
0:35.99 – 0:38.31	Those are replicas.
0:38.31 – 0:40.92	They share the same pile.
0:40.92 – 0:45.53	When nobody writes, Aurora Serverless takes a nap.
0:45.53 – 0:48.80	When Eddie writes, it wakes up.
0:48.80 – 0:51.97	AWS grows the pages.
0:51.97 – 1:00.00	Now you know Aurora!

CHAPTERS

0:00.00 – 0:17.26	Super notebook
0:17.26 – 0:23.67	MySQL · Postgres
0:23.67 – 0:32.29	Shared pages
0:32.29 – 0:40.92	Replicas

0:40.92 – 0:48.80 Naps

0:48.80 – 1:00.00 Wakes up

NEIGHBORS (KID WORD = AWS)

Super notebook = Amazon Aurora

Extra copies, extra fast

Aurora is the super notebook. Extra copies. Extra fast. It still speaks MySQL and PostgreSQL.

Aurora is MySQL- and PostgreSQL-compatible and faster than RDS. Storage grows automatically. Use it when you want RDS-like SQL with more speed and replicas.

Shared pile = Aurora storage

Write once. Everyone can read.

All the notebooks share one big pile of pages.

Aurora storage is a shared cluster volume, replicated across Availability Zones. Writers and readers see the same pages. Storage grows in 10 GB chunks as you write.

Extra copies = Aurora replicas

They share the same pile

Extra copies help the line stay short. Those are replicas. They share the same pile.

Aurora replicas read from the same storage volume, so lag is tiny compared with RDS read replicas that copy the whole engine. Promote a replica if the writer fails.

Nap time = Aurora Serverless

Wakes when Eddie writes

When nobody writes, Aurora Serverless takes a nap. When Eddie writes, it wakes up.

Aurora Serverless v2 scales capacity up and down with load. It can scale toward zero when idle — a nap — then wake on traffic. Good for spiky or unknown workloads.

Tidy notebook = Amazon RDS

The cousin

RDS is a tidy notebook. Aurora is the super notebook on top of that idea.

Pick RDS for a simple managed engine (including Oracle or SQL Server). Pick Aurora when you want MySQL/PostgreSQL with shared storage, lots of replicas, and optional Serverless.

QUIZ

1. What is the super notebook that still speaks MySQL and PostgreSQL?

Choices: Super notebook · Tidy notebook · Nap time

Answer: Super notebook (Amazon Aurora)

2. What is one big pile of pages every notebook shares?

Choices: Shared pile · Tidy notebook · Extra copies

Answer: Shared pile (Aurora storage)

3. What are extra copies that share the same pile?

Choices: Extra copies · Tidy notebook · Nap time

Answer: Extra copies (Aurora replicas)

4. What takes a nap when nobody writes, then wakes for Eddie?

Choices: Nap time · Super notebook · Tidy notebook

Answer: Nap time (Aurora Serverless)

RECAP

Super notebook. Shared pile. Replicas. A nap, then a wake. Now you know Aurora.

Yes! Aurora is the super notebook. Shared pages. Replicas share the pile. Serverless naps, then wakes. AWS grows the pages.

The nap

Sleeps when empty. Grows for a crowd. You pay for a sip.

Copy the Voice-over block. Timed lines are for editing. No storyteller kid in the picture — voice only.

VOICE-OVER (COPY THIS)

Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky! This is Episode 13. Aurora can stay wide awake. That is provisioned. Or Aurora can nap. That is Aurora Serverless. When the lemonade stand is empty, the notebook sleeps. You do not pay for a whole pitcher. You pay for a sip. When a crowd comes, it wakes and grows. ACU is how wide the pages get. Lulu pops in for one job, then she is gone. This notebook stays. It just takes a nap. Still MySQL. Still PostgreSQL. Same pile of pages. Now you know Aurora Serverless!

TIMED LINES

0:00.10 – 0:04.38	Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky!
0:04.38 – 0:07.05	This is Episode 13.
0:07.05 – 0:10.03	Aurora can stay wide awake.
0:10.03 – 0:12.29	That is provisioned.
0:12.29 – 0:14.78	Or Aurora can nap.
0:14.78 – 0:17.66	That is Aurora Serverless.
0:17.66 – 0:22.50	When the lemonade stand is empty, the notebook sleeps.
0:22.50 – 0:25.63	You do not pay for a whole pitcher.
0:25.63 – 0:27.93	You pay for a sip.
0:27.93 – 0:32.18	When a crowd comes, it wakes and grows.
0:32.18 – 0:35.68	ACU is how wide the pages get.
0:35.68 – 0:40.24	Lulu pops in for one job, then she is gone.
0:40.24 – 0:42.66	This notebook stays.
0:42.66 – 0:44.95	It just takes a nap.
0:44.95 – 0:47.46	Still MySQL.
0:47.46 – 0:50.14	Still PostgreSQL.
0:50.14 – 0:52.84	Same pile of pages.
0:52.84 – 1:00.00	Now you know Aurora Serverless!

CHAPTERS

0:00.00 – 0:17.66	Awake or nap
0:17.66 – 0:22.50	Empty stand
0:22.50 – 0:27.93	A sip
0:27.93 – 0:35.68	Grows

0:35.68 – 0:44.95 Not Lulu

0:44.95 – 1:00.00 Same pages

NEIGHBORS (KID WORD = AWS)

Wide awake = Provisioned Aurora

Stays on all day

Aurora can stay wide awake. That is provisioned.

Provisioned Aurora uses a chosen instance size 24/7. Best when the load is steady and high. You pay for the pitcher even if nobody drinks.

The nap = Aurora Serverless v2

Sleeps, then wakes

When the lemonade stand is empty, the notebook sleeps. It stays. It just takes a nap.

Aurora Serverless v2 scales capacity with traffic and can scale toward zero when idle. Same Aurora storage. Same MySQL/PostgreSQL. Use it for spiky, quiet, or unknown loads.

A sip = Pay per ACU

Not the whole pitcher

You do not pay for a whole pitcher. You pay for a sip.

You set a min and max ACU. Billing follows capacity in use. Cheaper than provisioned when the stand is often empty. A busy all-day stand may still be cheaper provisioned.

How wide = ACU

Pages get wider

When a crowd comes, it wakes and grows. ACU is how wide the pages get.

An Aurora Capacity Unit is CPU + memory. Serverless v2 scales in fine ACU steps so the notebook grows with the line instead of jumping to a huge size.

Lulu = AWS Lambda

One job, then gone

Lulu pops in for one job, then she is gone. This notebook stays.

Lambda is a function that runs and disappears. Aurora Serverless is still a database that keeps your pages. It only naps. Do not mix them up on the exam.

QUIZ

1. What stays wide awake all day?

Choices: Wide awake · The nap · Lulu

Answer: Wide awake (Provisioned Aurora)

2. What naps when the lemonade stand is empty?

Choices: The nap · Lulu · Wide awake

Answer: The nap (Aurora Serverless v2)

3. What is a sip instead of a whole pitcher?

Choices: A sip · How wide · Lulu

Answer: A sip (Pay per ACU)

4. What is how wide the pages get when a crowd comes?

Choices: How wide · Lulu · Wide awake

Answer: How wide (ACU)

RECAP

Awake or nap. Empty stand. A sip. Grows for a crowd. Not Lulu. Same pages. Now you know Aurora Serverless.

Yes! Provisioned stays awake. Serverless naps, then grows. You pay for a sip. ACU is how wide. Lulu leaves. The notebook stays.

The labeled cubbies

Grab by name. Super fast. No rows to turn.

Copy the Voice-over block. Timed lines are for editing. No storyteller kid in the picture — voice only.

VOICE-OVER (COPY THIS)

Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky! This is Episode 14. RDS is a tidy notebook. Aurora is a super notebook. You turn pages. DynamoDB is labeled cubbies. Grab by name. Super fast. No rows to turn. Eddie already knows the name. He does not hunt through a notebook. The name on the cubby is the partition key. The order inside is the sort key. When a cubby changes, a whisper goes out. That is a stream. Extra labels help you find things another way. Those are GSIs. Always on. No nap needed. Now you know DynamoDB!

TIMED LINES

0:00.10 – 0:04.38	Welcome back to Cloud Town, high up in the sky!
0:04.38 – 0:07.08	This is Episode 14.
0:07.08 – 0:10.17	RDS is a tidy notebook.
0:10.17 – 0:13.16	Aurora is a super notebook.
0:13.16 – 0:15.47	You turn pages.
0:15.47 – 0:18.86	DynamoDB is labeled cubbies.
0:18.86 – 0:20.88	Grab by name.
0:20.88 – 0:22.93	Super fast.
0:22.93 – 0:25.22	No rows to turn.
0:25.22 – 0:27.96	Eddie already knows the name.
0:27.96 – 0:31.00	He does not hunt through a notebook.
0:31.00 – 0:34.53	The name on the cubby is the partition key.
0:34.53 – 0:37.81	The order inside is the sort key.
0:37.81 – 0:41.74	When a cubby changes, a whisper goes out.
0:41.74 – 0:43.88	That is a stream.
0:43.88 – 0:47.76	Extra labels help you find things another way.
0:47.76 – 0:50.25	Those are GSIs.
0:50.25 – 0:52.12	Always on.
0:52.12 – 0:54.30	No nap needed.
0:54.30 – 1:00.00	Now you know DynamoDB!

CHAPTERS

0:00.00 – 0:18.86 Labeled cubbies

0:18.86 – 0:31.00 Grab by name

0:31.00 – 0:37.81 Keys

0:37.81 – 0:43.88 A whisper

0:43.88 – 0:50.25 Extra labels

0:50.25 – 1:00.00 Always on

NEIGHBORS (KID WORD = AWS)

Labeled cubbies = Amazon DynamoDB

Grab by name

DynamoDB is labeled cubbies. Grab by name. Super fast. No rows to turn.

DynamoDB is a serverless key-value and document database. You look up by key instead of scanning rows like SQL. Single-digit millisecond reads. Always on — no cluster to nap.

Name and order = Partition key / sort key

The cubby, then the row inside

The name on the cubby is the partition key. The order inside is the sort key.

The partition key sends the item to a cubby (partition). The sort key orders items inside that cubby. Together they are the primary key. Design the key for how you will grab.

A whisper = DynamoDB Streams

When a cubby changes

When a cubby changes, a whisper goes out. That is a stream. Lulu can listen.

DynamoDB Streams records item-level changes in order. Lambda can react — copy, count, or fan out. Use streams for near-real-time work, not for queries.

Extra labels = Global Secondary Index

Find things another way

Extra labels help you find things another way. Those are GSIs.

A Global Secondary Index is another key so you can query by a different attribute. You pay for that index. Local Secondary Indexes share the partition key but sort differently.

Super notebook = Amazon Aurora

You turn pages

RDS and Aurora are notebooks. You turn pages. Cubbies are for when you already know the name.

Pick Aurora/RDS for SQL joins and rows. Pick DynamoDB when access is by key, traffic is spiky, and you want managed scale without a cluster.

QUIZ

1. What are labeled cubbies you grab by name?

Choices: Labeled cubbies · Super notebook · Extra labels

Answer: Labeled cubbies (Amazon DynamoDB)

2. What is the name on the cubby, and the order inside?

Choices: Name and order · A whisper · Super notebook

Answer: Name and order (Partition key / sort key)

3. What is the whisper when a cubby changes?

Choices: A whisper · Extra labels · Labeled cubbies

Answer: A whisper (DynamoDB Streams)

4. What extra labels help you find things another way?

Choices: Extra labels · Name and order · Super notebook

Answer: Extra labels (Global Secondary Index)

RECAP

Cubbies. Grab by name. Keys. A whisper. Extra labels. Always on. Now you know DynamoDB.

Yes! Cubbies, not notebooks. Partition key and sort key. Streams whisper. GSIs are extra labels. Always on.